

SCW16-Doc00, Preliminary agenda

This paper compiles the current draft benchmark agenda for the abundance-index sessions. It combines the acoustic-session schedule prepared by IMARPE and IFOP and the CPUE-session agenda developed at the CPUE coordination meeting held on 14 April 2026.

Participants in the acoustic drafting committee included Criscely Lujan, Daniel Ramos, Mariano Gutiérrez, Ignacio Payá, Victor Catasti, and José Zenteno.

Participants in the CPUE coordination meeting included Criscely Lujan, Miriam Geronimo, Erich Diaz, Ignacio Payá, José Zenteno, Sebastián Vásquez, and Niels Hintzen.

Day 1. Preliminary Acoustic Session Agenda

- **Start time:** 09:00

Session 1

Time	Topic	Presenter
09:00-09:20	Historical review of hydroacoustic survey programs in north-central Chile	V. Catasti (IFOP)
09:20-09:40	Preliminary results of the 2026 north-central Chile hydroacoustic survey	V. Catasti (IFOP)
09:40-10:00	Oceanography conditions during the 2026 acoustic survey	J. Letelier (IFOP)
10:00-10:20	Spatio-temporal modeling of acoustic backscatter (Sa) from the north-central Chile survey using <code>sdmTMB</code>	I. Payá and V. Catasti (IFOP)

Time	Topic	Presenter
10:20-10:40	Coffee break	
10:40-11:00	Toward a standardised abundance index for Chilean jack mackerel: spatio-temporal modelling of acoustic survey data in northern Chile	M.G. Pennino, S. Vásquez, N. Alegría, and A. Sepúlveda (INPESCA)
11:00-11:20	Opportunistic acoustic data collection using the south-central Chilean commercial fleet	N. Alegría (INPESCA)
11:20-11:40	Review of jack mackerel acoustic assessments conducted in Peru	Daniel Grados (IMARPE)

Session 2

Time	Topic	Presenter
11:40-12:00	Application of sonar systems in Peruvian anchoveta fisheries and potential applicability for jack mackerel in Peru and Chile	M. Gutiérrez (Instituto Humboldt de Investigación Marina y Acuícola)
12:00-13:30	Lunch break (1 hour 30 minutes)	

Session 3

Time	Topic	Presenter
13:30-14:30	Examination and/or validation of jack mackerel echograms	All participants
14:30-14:50	Coffee break	
14:50-16:00	General discussion	All participants
16:00-17:00	Technical recommendations	All participants

Day 2. Preliminary CPUE Session Agenda ([SCW16-Doc02](#))

The Day 2 CPUE session is currently organized as a thematic sequence. Exact time allocations and presenters remain to be confirmed. Background for these discussions is provided in [SCW16-Doc02](#), which summarizes the CPUE coordination discussion and candidate topics for the benchmark session.

Order	Topic	Notes
1	Metadata by fleet and country	Review fleet definitions, spatial coverage, observation level, and index construction by country and fishery.
2	Methods by fleet and country	Compare GLM, spatio-temporal models, GLMMs with spatio-temporal random effects, and latitude-longitude smoothing approaches.
3	Comparative analysis and parsimony across candidate indices	Evaluate traditional GLM, spatio-temporal, and environmentally informed approaches and identify the most suitable benchmark candidates.
4	Effort-creep review and decision for stock assessment use	Revisit current effort-creep assumptions and consider whether revised treatment is needed for benchmark runs.
5	Catchability-availability blocks by abundance index	Review evidence for temporal or spatial changes in availability, including possible El Niño effects and implications for q blocks.
6	CPUE weighting factors for stock assessment	Discuss weighting choices and how they affect assessment fits and benchmark comparisons.

Order	Topic	Notes
7	Separate versus combined index products for HCR use	Consider whether the benchmark should retain separate series or define a combined CPUE product for OM conditioning and MP inputs.

Day 3. Recap, Report Drafting, and Biological Inputs

The morning session will be used to recap the Acoustic and CPUE sessions, identify remaining loose ends, and begin drafting the corresponding report sections. The objective is to document decisions, unresolved technical issues, and follow-up tasks while the index discussions are still current.

The afternoon session will begin with a summary of SCW16-Doc01 and its implications for benchmark and MSE development. This will be followed by a review of the biological assumptions used in the assessment and operating-model conditioning, including growth, maturity, natural mortality, weight-at-age, stock structure, and recruitment-productivity assumptions. The discussion should identify options for refining model runs and for defining a compact set of assessment and OM alternatives for further evaluation.

Session	Topic	Notes
Morning	Acoustic and CPUE recap and report drafting	Summarize key conclusions, outstanding questions, and text needed for the workshop report.
Afternoon	SCW16-Doc01 summary and biological inputs	Review assessment simplification results, biological assumptions, and options for refined model runs.

Day 4. Projections, Recruitment Scenarios, and OM Specifications

Day 4 will advance discussion of assessment-model projections, recruitment scenarios, and operating-model specifications. This should include how projection assumptions connect to benchmark assessment runs, how alternative recruitment histories or productivity regimes should be represented, and how operating-model sets should be structured for MSE testing.

The session should also review MCMC evaluations and any technical constraints that affect their use, including convergence diagnostics, run time, storage, parameterization, and feasibility for candidate assessment and operating-model configurations.

Session	Topic	Notes
Morning	Assessment projections and recruitment scenarios	Review projection assumptions, recruitment windows, productivity regimes, and links to benchmark assessment runs.
Afternoon	OM specifications and MCMC evaluations	Define candidate OM specifications and document MCMC diagnostics, feasibility, and technical constraints.

Day 5. Final Decisions and Report Adoption

Day 5 will focus on finalizing workshop decisions and completing report drafting. The goal is to agree on recommendations, document any unresolved issues, and adopt the workshop report for consideration by SC14.

Session	Topic	Notes
Morning	Final decisions and recommendations	Confirm agreed benchmark inputs, model-run priorities, OM specifications, and follow-up tasks.
Afternoon	Report drafting and adoption	Finalize report text and adopt the report for SC14 consideration.